

PLANNING AND DESIGN DOCUMENTATION

Pastimes — Pre-loved Brands, New Stories

WEDE6021 Portfolio of Evidence

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1. Introduction

This document records the planning and design work I was responsible for on Pastimes, a full-stack PHP and MySQL web application that lets users buy and sell second-hand branded clothing. Before any code was written, the project needed a clear direction: what the site had to do, who it was for, how its pages and data would be organised, and how it would look and feel. That groundwork is the focus of this documentation.

2. My Role in the Project

Within the team, my duty covered the planning and design phase rather than the PHP/MySQL build itself. This meant translating the project brief into concrete objectives, structuring the site's information architecture, mapping out user roles and flows, contributing to the planning of the underlying data model, and establishing the visual design system and page layouts that the development phase implemented.

3. Planning Phase

3.1 Project Objectives

The brief called for a working online marketplace with registration, item listings, a cart, checkout and an admin dashboard. I translated this into four working objectives: let buyers browse and purchase pre-owned clothing with confidence, let verified sellers list items easily, give administrators control over user and listing approval, and build trust around items that are, by nature, second-hand.

3.2 Target Audience

Two user groups were identified: budget-conscious and sustainability-minded shoppers seeking affordable branded clothing, and individuals wanting to resell clothing they no longer wear. This shaped design decisions such as displaying item condition (excellent, good or fair) prominently on every listing, and introducing a seller verification step before anyone can list items for sale.

3.3 Site Map and Navigation

Before development began, I grouped the required pages by function to form the site map below, which then determined the structure of the global navigation bar (Home, Browse, Sell, How It Works) and a role-aware Profile dropdown containing Orders, Addresses, List Item for sellers, and an Admin Panel link for administrators.

Section	Pages	Purpose
Public	Home, Browse, Item Detail, How It Works	Discovery and browsing for all visitors
Account	Login, Register, Profile (Orders / Addresses tabs)	Manage identity and account details
Transactional	Cart, Checkout	Convert browsing into a completed order
Seller	Sell / List Item	Verified sellers create new listings
Admin	Admin Dashboard	Approve sellers, manage users and listings

3.4 User Roles and User Flows

Three roles were planned with escalating permissions: Buyer (browse, purchase, message sellers), Seller (all buyer permissions plus item listing, gated behind verification), and Admin (full access, including verifying sellers and managing users and listings). For each role I outlined the primary journey, for example the buyer path of Browse → Item Detail → Add to Cart → Checkout → Order Confirmation, and the seller path of Register → Request Seller Status → Await Verification → List Item. These flows guided which pages needed to link to which, and what state (logged out, buyer, pending seller, verified seller, admin) each page needed to account for.

3.5 Database and Content Planning

Working alongside the data design, I planned the core entities the application needed to track and how they relate to one another: users, addresses, items, item photos, cart entries, orders and messages. Each item belongs to one seller; each order links a buyer, an item and a delivery address; each item can carry multiple photos; and messages connect a buyer and seller around a

specific item. Setting this out before the tables were built gave the development side a clear, agreed structure to implement.

4. Design Phase

4.1 Wireframing

Each key page was laid out in wireframe form before any visual styling was applied. This stage decided where the hero banner, category filters and item grid would sit on the home and browse pages, and how the item detail page would balance product photography against price, condition and seller information, so that the structure of every page was settled before colour, type or imagery were added.

4.2 Visual Design System

A consistent visual identity was established for the brand, Pastimes — Pre-loved Brands, New Stories, built around the tokens below. The navy and teal palette was chosen to read as trustworthy and considered rather than fast-fashion, supporting the second-hand positioning, while Poppins was selected for its clean, friendly, geometric letterforms, which stay legible across headings, buttons and body text alike.

Element	Value
Primary colour	Navy — #082B59
Accent colour	Teal — #0D8B8B
Typeface	Poppins (Google Fonts)
Corner radius	8px / 12px / 20px (small / medium / large components)
Elevation	Soft drop shadow on cards, panels and dropdowns

4.3 Page Layout Design

Layout logic was defined for each major page:

- Home — announcement bar, hero section, How It Works steps, and featured items
- Browse — filter sidebar paired with a sortable item grid, each card showing brand, price and condition
- Item Detail — photo gallery alongside an information panel with seller details and an add-to-cart action
- Cart and Checkout — itemised order summary, address selection, and order total
- Profile — tabbed layout separating personal details, order history and saved addresses
- Admin Dashboard — summary statistics above management tables for users and listings

4.4 Usability Considerations

As part of the design, every form across the site was specified to behave as a sticky form: if a submission fails validation, the values a user already entered remain in place rather than being cleared, reducing friction during registration, login, listing creation and checkout.

5. Tools and Methods Used

Wire framing and diagramming tools were used to plan the site map, user flows and page layouts, and the resulting colour palette, typography and spacing scale were documented as a small set of reusable design tokens so the development phase could apply them consistently across every page rather than re-deciding them page by page.

6. Conclusion

The planning and design phase set the direction for the rest of the Pastimes build. By defining the objectives, audience, site map, user roles, data relationships and visual identity before development started, the team had a clear and consistent reference to build from, resulting in an application whose structure and appearance directly reflect the original brief.